

Brand & Packaging Blueprint

Choose a name and look that feels like a real small business, pack pieces so they survive shipping, and send a care card that keeps customers coming back.

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SECTION 1

Naming Your Brand

By the end of this section you'll have a short list of name candidates and a way to pick the final one.

A good craft brand name is short, easy to say out loud, and tells people roughly what you make — it doesn't need to be clever, it needs to be memorable.

Step by step

- 1 Brainstorm 15-20 names in one sitting.** Mix your own name ("Maya's Resin Studio"), a material or theme word (wave, bloom, geode, amber, tide), and a craft word (studio, co, lab, works, atelier) — quantity first, judgment later.
- 2 Say each one out loud.** If it's hard to say clearly or sounds like another word when spoken, cross it off — word of mouth only works if the name survives being spoken.
- 3 Check availability where it matters to you.** Search your shortlist as a shop name on the marketplace you picked in The Marketplace Method, and as a username on whichever one social platform you plan to use — you don't need it everywhere, just where you'll actually show up.
- 4 Pick one and commit for at least 6 months.** Changing your shop name resets reviews and recognition on most platforms — treat the first name as a real decision, not a placeholder.

Do this

Keep it under 3 words and avoid numbers or hyphens where possible. Shorter names are easier to remember, easier to search, and easier to fit on a small packaging label.

Checklist

- ☐ Brainstormed at least 15 name candidates
- ☐ Said top 3 candidates out loud to someone else
- ☐ Checked availability on your chosen selling platform and one social handle
- ☐ Picked a final name

SECTION 2

A Simple, Consistent Look

By the end of this section you'll have one color palette, one font pairing, and a simple logo mark you can reuse everywhere.

Consistency reads as "professional" far more than complexity does. The same two colors and the same font on every photo, label, and card is what makes a one-person shop feel established.

Step by step

- 1 **Pick 2-3 colors from your actual pieces.** Choose colors that already show up in the resin and pigments you use most, so your branding visually matches what you sell instead of clashing with it.
- 2 **Pick one display font and one plain text font.** One for your shop name and headers, one for everything else (descriptions, care cards) — free font pairings are widely available and plenty for a small shop.
- 3 **Make a simple text-based logo first.** Your shop name set in your chosen font, in your chosen color, is a completely legitimate logo to start with — a custom illustrated mark can come later once you know your name is final.
- 4 **Save your colors and fonts in one place.** A simple note with the color codes and font names means every future label, card, or photo edit matches, even months from now.



Common mistake

Picking a trendy color palette that doesn't match your actual pieces. If your branding is cool-toned blue and your best sellers are warm ambers and golds, the mismatch undercuts the professional look you're going for.

SECTION 3

Packaging That Protects, Not Just Impresses

By the end of this section you'll be able to pack any piece so it survives shipping without overspending on materials.

Protection comes first, branding comes second. A beautifully branded box that arrives with a cracked coaster inside loses the customer anyway.

Step by step

- 1 Choose a box sized close to the piece.** Too much empty space lets the item shift and slam into the box walls during transit — a snug fit with cushioning on all sides beats a huge box with items rattling inside.
- 2 Cushion with low-cost materials first.** Crumpled kraft paper, newspaper, or air pillows protect just as well as branded tissue paper — spend on protection, not on things that only look nice in an unboxing photo.
- 3 Add one branded touch, not five.** A single sticker with your logo on the tape, or one card with your shop name, gives a polished feel without adding real cost per order.
- 4 Seal with proper packing tape, not household tape.** Wide, strong packing tape across every seam keeps the box from opening in transit, especially if it gets rained on or handled roughly.
- 5 Weigh and measure the sealed box before buying postage.** Guessing the weight is the most common reason sellers pay a shipping fee surprise, either underpaying and getting a postage-due notice or overpaying out of caution.

PIECE TYPE	PACKAGING PRIORITY	LOW-COST CUSHIONING OPTION
Jewelry (earrings, pendants)	Prevent chain tangling and a small box getting crushed	Small jewelry box inside a padded mailer
Coasters / flat decor	Prevent flexing and corner chips	Rigid cardboard inserts above and below the stack

PIECE TYPE	PACKAGING PRIORITY	LOW-COST CUSHIONING OPTION
Trays / large decor	Prevent impact cracks from drops	2+ inches of cushioning on every side, snug-fit box

Checklist

- ☐ Box size matches the piece, with no large empty gaps
- ☐ Cushioning on all sides, not just top and bottom
- ☐ One simple branded touch included (sticker, card, or stamped tape)
- ☐ Package weighed and measured before buying postage

SECTION 4

The Care Card

By the end of this section you'll have a care card template ready to print and include with every order.

A care card does two jobs at once: it prevents the "how do I clean this?" messages, and it's a small, physical reminder of your brand that sits in the customer's home.

Step by step

- 1 State how to clean the piece.** For most cured resin pieces: wipe with a soft, damp cloth and a drop of mild soap; avoid abrasive scrubbers, which can dull the glossy finish over time.
- 2 State what to avoid.** Prolonged direct sunlight can yellow some resins over months or years, and very high heat (like a hot pan set directly on a resin trivet without a trivet pad) can warp or damage a piece — mention whichever applies to that specific item.
- 3 Be honest about food contact.** Only tell a customer a piece is food-safe if you used a resin rated for that use by its manufacturer and cured it for the full time the manufacturer specifies — otherwise, label the piece as decorative use only, or for serving items that don't directly touch food (like a tray under a plate) rather than claiming a food-safe status you can't back up.
- 4 Add your shop name and a short thank-you line.** Keep it to one or two sentences — this is a care card, not a sales flyer.
- 5 Keep the design on-brand but simple.** Reuse the colors and font from Section 2 so the card matches your packaging and listing photos.

Safety and honesty

Never state or imply a piece is "food safe" or "food grade" unless the specific resin's manufacturer rates it for food contact and you followed its full cure time. When in doubt, label the piece as decorative use only.



Checklist

- ☐ Cleaning instructions included
- ☐ Honest statement about heat, sunlight, and food contact for this specific piece
- ☐ Shop name and a short thank-you line
- ☐ Design matches your brand colors and fonts

SECTION 5

Putting It All Together

By the end of this section you'll have a repeatable packing routine you can run on every single order.

The goal isn't a perfect first attempt — it's a routine simple enough that you'll actually follow it on order 50 the same way you did on order 1.

Step by step

- 1 Lay out your packing station once.** Box, cushioning material, tape, care cards, and your branded sticker or stamp, all within arm's reach, so packing an order takes minutes instead of a search through drawers.
- 2 Build a short written routine.** Wrap → cushion → add care card → seal → label → photograph before sealing — the same five or six steps every time removes guesswork and reduces damaged shipments.
- 3 Batch your packing when you have multiple orders.** Doing all your wrapping, then all your boxing, then all your labeling is faster than finishing one order fully before starting the next.
- 4 Review your packaging every 10-15 orders.** If you're seeing damage reports or questions repeating, that's your signal to adjust cushioning or box size — not something to guess at in advance.

Checklist

- ☐ Packing station set up with everything within reach
- ☐ Written packing routine (even a short sticky note) posted at your station
- ☐ Plan to review packaging after every 10-15 orders

Next Step

You now have the full system: how to make a piece, sell it, and ship it like a real brand. Open your library and start your first piece — pick one project, follow the steps, and let your first sale teach you more than any course can.